6.20 Liver Cirrhosis

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My abdomen and legs are swollen." **Objective** • Ascites • Edema in both legs • Albumin 25 g/L	**ACTUAL** **Excess fluid volume** related to portal hypertension and low albumin as evidenced by ascites and edema.	Within 1 week, weight and abdominal girth are coming down.	• Weigh daily and measure abdominal girth. • Limit sodium as prescribed. • Give diuretics as prescribed, and watch potassium and sodium. • Raise the legs.	Weight and girth falling: **goal met**.
Subjective • "The itching does not let me sleep." **Objective** • Jaundice • Scratch marks on the skin	**ACTUAL** **Impaired comfort** related to pruritus from bile salts as evidenced by itching and scratch marks.	Says the itching is less.	• Keep nails short and the skin moisturised. • Cool baths, not hot water. • Give the antipruritic as ordered.	Less itching: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • INR prolonged • Platelets low • Varices	**RISK** **Risk for bleeding** as evidenced by risk factors: impaired clotting and portal hypertension.	No bleeding.	• Follow INR, platelets and Hb. • Soft toothbrush and electric razor only. • No IM injections. • Teach the signs of GI bleeding.	No bleeding: **goal met**.